

Student Empowerment Initiative

Rural Outreach Program

By Students, For Students

Submitted by:



Nepalese Society of Student Researchers (NSSR)
Kathmandu, Nepal

Submitted to:

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[omit submitted to, prepared by (text), section if you are doing it for general]

[Recipient Institution / Organization]

[City, Country]

August 22, 2026

Program Overview

Program Title	Student Empowerment Initiative (SEI) - By Students, For Students
Organized By	Nepalese Society of Student Researchers (NSSR)
Submitted To	[Recipient institution / organization]
Proposed Date(s)	[Date(s)]
Venue	2–3 rural or underserved schools across Nepal, to be finalised jointly with [Recipient Bank Name]
Target Audience	2000+ students, Grades 1–12, across all locations combined
Duration	1 full day of hands-on science learning
Mentorship Duration	Monthly sessions across the 2026–27 academic year at the pilot school
Funding/Support Requested	See Estimated Budget (tiered: launch events, digital learning pilot, mentorship, and reference library are each separable)
Key Objective	Deliver hands-on science exposure and STEM career awareness to students in rural Nepal with a sustained, near-peer mentorship model

1. Introduction

The Nepalese Society of Student Researchers (NSSR) respectfully submits this proposal for the Student Empowerment Initiative: Rural Science & Digital Learning Outreach Program, seeking [Recipient Bank Name]'s partnership to support rural and underserved schools across Nepal over the 2026–27 academic year. This proposal is structured to align with [Recipient Bank Name]'s Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) obligations under Nepal Rastra Bank's CSR framework, offering a documented program that fits within the “Social Projects” CSR head.

Earlier outreach models in this space, including NSSR's own prior work, have typically taken the form of a single one-day event: a visit, a set of experiments, a handover of equipment, and no further contact. This proposal deliberately moves beyond that model. It combines a hands-on launch event (which still delivers the reach, visibility, and immediate spark that a one-day format is good at) with a sustained, low-cost mentorship and learning-resource layer at one pilot school designed specifically around what the evidence and the data say rural Nepali students actually need most (see Section 3).

2. About NSSR

NSSR is a student-led, non-profit research organisation registered under Nepal's Company Act and based in Kathmandu. It works to build a genuine research culture among Nepal's student community by bridging the gap between theoretical education and real-world application through workshops, fellowships, and outreach initiatives. NSSR is affiliated with the Global Student Forum (GSF), connecting its student researchers with a wider network of youth-led science and research initiatives worldwide.

2.1 Track Record

Metric	Reach
Active students	2000+
Research-training sessions, workshops & public talks conducted	15+
University & academic institution collaborations	10+
International Collaborations	3

2.2 Major Past Activities

Program	Partner(s)	Focus
Quantum Computing Crash Course	St. Xavier's College, Maitighar	Introductory crash course on quantum computing concepts and applications
Scientific Writing & LaTeX Workshop	Far Western University (FWU YouthMappers, School of Engineering), Kanchanpur	6-day hands-on workshop strengthening research and academic writing skills
NSSR-DataCamp Fellowship	DataCamp, New York City, USA	Free, structured online data-science training
Pathways: Research, Leadership & Global Opportunities	Aspire Institute, Cambridge, Massachusetts, USA	Guidance on research pathways, leadership development, and global opportunities for students
AI Native Program	NAAMII & the European Union (EU)	Applied AI/ML capacity-building program
Science Beyond the Classroom (SBC)	—	Igniting student curiosity by exploring captivating scientific concepts.

3. Background / Motivation

Science education is part of Nepal's national curriculum, but rural schools face severe constraints in delivering practical, lab-based learning. The gap below reflects the reality NSSR encountered at its first outreach site, Shree Bhotang-Devi Secondary School in Thangpalkot, Sindhupalchok, and is consistent with national data.

Indicator	Urban Schools	Rural Schools
Science lab access	~80% have functional labs	< 15% have functional labs
Qualified science teachers	Average 3–5 per school	Average 0–1 per school
Students pursuing STEM (Grade 12+)	~55%	~18%
Practical experiment sessions / year	20–40 sessions	0–3 sessions
SLC / SEE pass rate Science	~72%	~38%

Sources: [1]–[3].

Read together, these numbers point to a specific conclusion: the primary constraint facing most rural science students is not a lack of curiosity or exposure—it is that most of them are simply struggling to pass. A 38 percent science pass rate means the majority of rural science students are currently failing the subject outright. Any intervention that focuses purely on inspiration or career awareness, without addressing this more basic and urgent problem, risks helping the students who are already succeeding while doing little for the majority who are not.

This is also why NSSR has designed this program around sustained contact rather than a single visit. Evidence from near-peer mentoring research mentoring delivered by university-level students rather than professional teachers or distant experts is particularly effective for rural and underrepresented students, since the effect comes from relatability rather than expertise [4]. A monthly mentorship series run for rural high-school students found that interest in, and likelihood of pursuing, a STEM career increased significantly over the course of the series, even though individual session surveys on their own showed no significant change, indicating it is sustained, repeated contact, not a single visit, that drives the effect [5]. Single, one-off outreach events are correspondingly associated with a weaker and shorter-lived impact on student attitudes toward science [6]. A one-day visit can spark interest; it cannot, by itself, close a pass-rate gap of this size.

4. Alignment with NRB's CSR Directive

Nepal Rastra Bank requires all BFIs to maintain a CSR fund of at least 1 percent of net profit and to spend it across specified CSR heads, disclosing the breakdown by head and by province in annual financial statements. Class A commercial banks and national-level financial institutions are further required to spend a minimum of 10 percent of their CSR fund in each province [7]. This program is designed to fit directly within that framework:

CSR Head (NRB Unified Directive)	Relevance to This Program
Social Projects	Education, health, natural disasters, environmental protection, and infrastructural improvements in rural areas; the launch events, digital learning pilot, mentorship program, and reference library all fall directly under this head.
Direct Donation / SDG Activities	Applicable if the bank wishes to frame its contribution as direct support to an underserved school, and aligns with SDG (Quality Education).

Nepal Rastra Bank's own review of the industry found that the average bank CSR contribution stood at 1.58 percent of net profit in FY 2019/20, above the regulatory minimum, but that only 38.5 percent of commercial banks disclosed a breakdown of their CSR expenses by head in their annual reports indicating that transparent, well-documented reporting, not fund availability, is the more common compliance gap across the industry [8]. This proposal is structured to close that specific gap: every component below (Section 10) is separately costed and documented, giving [Recipient Bank Name] a disclosure-ready breakdown by head and by activity rather than a single lump-sum contribution.

Because the launch events can run in 2–3 different districts and accept both cash and in-kind contributions, they can also support a bank's provincial diversification requirement within a single CSR cycle, while the digital learning pilot and reference library give the bank a durable, documented, single-site case study for its own reporting to the Board and to NRB.

5. Objectives

1. Deliver hands-on, experiment-based science learning in Physics, Chemistry, and Biology to 600+ students across 2–3 rural schools.
2. Leave each host school with a durable set of lab equipment and teaching materials after the launch event.
3. At one pilot school, install classroom projectors and connectivity across up to 5 rooms, creating a curated video learning library usable by every class, every day not only by the mentee cohort.
4. Run a monthly near-peer mentorship program for Grade 9–12 students (or Grade 9–10 where no +2 program exists) at the pilot school, built around topics the school's own science and mathematics teachers identify as the students' greatest areas of struggle.
5. Establish a curated, syllabus-aligned reference library (guide books, model question sets, and entrance-exam preparation material) at the pilot school.
6. Provide [Recipient Bank Name] with a documented, reportable CSR partnership spanning both a broad one-time reach (launch events) and a sustained, single-site model (digital pilot, mentorship, library).

6. Target Group

Grades 3–10 students at 2–3 rural or underserved secondary schools, prioritising schools with no functioning science laboratory and limited access to qualified science teachers, are reached through the launch events. Approximately 200+ students are expected per location, 600+ across the full series.

At the pilot school selected for the digital learning and mentorship components, the monthly program targets Grade 9–12 students, organised into two cohorts where the school offers a +2 program:

- Foundational cohort (Grade 9–10) SEE-focused, prioritised at every pilot site since this is where the national rural pass-rate gap is most acute.
- Advanced cohort (Grade 11–12) included only where the pilot school itself runs a +2 program. Where it does not (common, since +2 is frequently a separate institution in rural Nepal), the mentorship instead extends to include Grade 9 as a standard part of the Foundational cohort, keeping the program to two manageable grade-bands rather than four separate sessions.

Specific schools, and the pilot site among them, will be confirmed in consultation with [Recipient Bank Name], particularly if the bank has a preferred district or existing branch footprint subject to an electricity and mobile-network feasibility check at candidate pilot sites.

7. Structure of Program

The program runs in two connected layers: a broad one-day launch event at each of 2–3 schools, and a deeper, sustained pilot at one of those schools. The launch events deliver immediate reach and give the bank the visible, multi-district CSR footprint required for provincial disclosure. The pilot is where the program's actual impact on learning outcomes is designed to show up, since sustained contact is what the evidence (Section 3) identifies as the difference-maker.

7.1 Phase 1 One-Day Hands-On Science Launch Events

Each of the 2–3 launch locations follows a proven one-day, on-site format covering hands-on experiments in Physics, Chemistry, and Biology, followed by a STEM career awareness discussion. At the close of each event, all lab equipment and teaching materials procured for the program are formally handed over to the host school for continued use by students and teachers.

7.2 Phase 2 Digital Learning Pilot (One School Only)

One of the 2–3 launch schools is selected as the digital learning pilot site, following a feasibility check of grid electricity stability and mobile network coverage. Up to 5 classrooms (e.g. Grade 9, 10, 11, 12, and a staff/library room) are equipped with a projector and voltage protection, and the school is connected via a mobile-network internet package. This infrastructure serves two purposes: it displays a curated video learning library (Phase 4) usable by any teacher in daily lessons, and it hosts the live monthly mentorship sessions (Phase 3) using a single, portable, higher-quality conferencing unit shared across whichever room is in use that day rather than lower-quality equipment duplicated in every room.

7.3 Phase 3 Monthly Near-Peer Mentorship Program

NSSR student researchers and advisors connect with the pilot school's Grade 9–12 cohort (see Section 6) once a month across the academic year, in two cohorts (Foundational and Advanced) run on separate days within the same month to keep each session small and genuinely interactive rather than a one-way broadcast a tiered, grade-banded structure consistent with near-peer STEM mentoring programs shown to be effective at this scale [9]. Even on technically complex topics, mentors close in age and experience to their mentees have demonstrated strong engagement outcomes in comparable rural and remote outreach programs [10]. Each monthly session follows a consistent three-part structure:

- Concept clinic (primary focus, most sessions): the school's science and mathematics teachers flag, in advance, the specific topics students are most struggling with. NSSR mentors address exactly those topics, explaining them through models and reasoning rather than repeating textbook memorisation, tying back where possible to what students touched hands-on during the launch event.
- Applied reasoning / critical thinking: working through SEE-style application questions on the same topics, focusing on how to reason to an answer rather than what the answer is. This builds the higher-order thinking skill while remaining directly exam-relevant.
- Pathway and career guidance (occasional, roughly one session in four): STEM career exposure, university and scholarship application guidance, and exam-strategy discussion for Grade 11–12 students where applicable.

Mentorship content is deliberately scoped to academic, research-pathway, and exam-related guidance. Sessions are conducted with a teacher or school staff member present as chaperone, and NSSR maintains a written mentor code of conduct and a rolling roster of trained student mentors (with backups) to ensure continuity even as senior NSSR mentors and Grade 12 students graduate mid-program. This sustained, repeated-contact format is also associated with stronger development of students' "science identity" and their self-perception as someone capable of doing science compared with one-off exposure alone [11].

7.4 Phase 4 Curated Digital Content Library

In consultation with the pilot school's science and mathematics teachers, NSSR compiles a curated, syllabus-matched playlist of existing online educational content, organised by subject and topic and made available for teachers to use in ordinary classroom teaching independent of, and in addition to, the live monthly mentorship calls. This is intended as a durable resource: it continues to function with zero NSSR presence required, keeps working after the CSR funding cycle ends, and benefits every class that uses the school's projectors, not only the mentee cohort.

7.5 Phase 5 Curated Reference Library (Books)

NSSR establishes a small, curated reference library at the pilot school (Grade 9–12 where the school offers a +2 program, otherwise Grade 9–10), consisting of syllabus-aligned guide books, solved past-paper and model-question sets, and, for the Grade 11–12 cohort where applicable, engineering and medical entrance-exam preparation material. Book selection is made in consultation with the school's science and mathematics teachers to ensure syllabus alignment, and a designated teacher or student librarian is agreed with the school to manage day-to-day lending once NSSR is not physically present.

8. What [Recipient Bank Name] Will Gain

1. **Visibility:** Name featured across banners, facilitator materials, and the post-program impact report for every location funded, reaching 600+ students and their surrounding communities, plus ongoing visibility at the pilot school throughout the academic year.
2. **CSR Compliance Documentation:** A structured report per location covering beneficiaries reached, funds or materials utilised, and outcomes achieved, suitable for NRB-mandated CSR disclosure by head and by province.
3. **A Renewable, Documented Case Study:** A phased pilot the bank can point to in year two “if this works at one site, we scale it” rather than a single unrepeated event.
4. **Talent Access:** Visibility into a curated, research-oriented student network through NSSR's 2,000+ active student base.
5. **Networking:** Introductions to NSSR's academic and institutional partner network, including university physics departments and research councils.
6. **Recognition:** Certificate of partnership and formal acknowledgment at every event.

9. Requested Support

NSSR welcomes support in either of the following forms, or a combination of both. The program is structured in separable components (Section 10), so the bank may choose to fund the launch events only, or extend support to the digital pilot, mentorship program, and reference library:

1. Financial contribution toward the program budget (amount per Section 10, scaling with the number of locations and components funded).
2. In-kind material contribution: lab equipment, chemistry and biology consumables, teaching aids, classroom projectors, stationery, or banners and printed materials, sourced or supplied directly by the bank in place of the equivalent cash line item.
3. Optional: coordination support in identifying a host district aligned with the bank's existing CSR footprint or provincial diversification requirement.

10. Estimated Budget

The budget is presented in four separable components. Items marked “can be provided in-kind” may be fulfilled through direct material contribution instead of cash. Any balance beyond a partial contribution will be covered by NSSR through internal fundraising, consistent with its practice on prior outreach programs.

10.1 Component A One-Day Launch Events (per location, repeated for each site funded)

S.N.	Item / Description	Qty	Rate (NPR)	Amount (NPR)	Remarks
1	Lab equipment & experiment materials	10 sets	1,000	10,000	Can be provided in-kind
2	Chemistry reagents & consumables	1 set	3,500	3,500	Can be provided in-kind
3	Biology & environment teaching aids	1 set	3,000	3,000	Can be provided in-kind
4	Facilitator transportation & logistics (8 members × NPR 8,000)	8	8,000	64,000	Cash preferred
5	Equipment donated to host school (retained after program)	1 set	15,000	15,000	Can be provided in-kind
6	Banners, stationery, worksheets, certificates	1 set	19,500	19,500	Can be provided in-kind
7	Contingency (~5%)	–	–	6,000	Cash only
	Cost per Location			121,000	

Series Total	Amount (NPR)
2 locations	242,000
3 locations	363,000

10.2 Component B Digital Learning Pilot (One School Only, One-Time Setup)

S.N.	Item / Description	Qty	Rate (NPR)	Amount (NPR)	Remarks
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1	Classroom projector with built-in speaker (~4,000 lumens)	5	35,000	175,000	Can be provided in-kind
2	All-in-one conference camera + mic + speaker (portable, shared across rooms)	2	30,000	60,000	Cash preferred
3	Voltage stabiliser / surge protector (per room)	5	4,000	20,000	Can be provided in-kind
4	Mounting & installation	5	2,500	12,500	Cash preferred
5	Connectivity setup + Year 1 subscription (mobile-network broadband)	1	9,500	9,500	Cash only
	Digital Pilot Total (Year 1)			277,000	

From Year 2 onward, recurring cost is limited to connectivity renewal (~NPR 9,500/year) a small annual renewal ask rather than a repeated capital cost.

10.3 Component C Monthly Near-Peer Mentorship (Pilot School, per Academic Year)

S.N.	Item / Description	Basis	Rate (NPR)	Amount (NPR)	Remarks
1	NSSR mentor honorarium, per mentor per online session (2 mentors/session, ~9 months)	Up to 36 mentor-sessions (2 cohorts) or 18 (1 cohort, if no Grade 11–12 at pilot school)	1,000	18,000 – 36,000	Cash only

10.4 Component D Curated Reference Library (Pilot School, Books Only)

S.N.	Item / Description	Amount (NPR)	Remarks
1	Curated syllabus-aligned books: guide books, solved past-paper /	100,000	Cash preferred (book procurement); no infrastructure included

	model-question sets, and entrance-exam preparation material (Grade 9–12 where the school offers a +2 program, otherwise Grade 9–10)		
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10.5 Total Program Investment

Configuration	Component A (Launch Events)	Component B (Digital Pilot)	Component C (Mentorship, Yr 1)	Component D (Library)	Total (NPR)
2 locations, full 9–12 mentorship	242,000	277,000	36,000	100,000	655,000
2 locations, 9–10 mentorship only	242,000	277,000	18,000	100,000	637,000
3 locations, full 9–12 mentorship	363,000	277,000	36,000	100,000	776,000
3 locations, 9–10 mentorship only	363,000	277,000	18,000	100,000	758,000

Each component is separable. The bank may fund Component A alone, or any combination the total adjusts accordingly.

11. Expected Outcomes

1. 600+ students engaged in hands-on science learning across 2–3 launch locations.
2. 100% student participation in at least one experiment per location, across Physics, Chemistry, or Biology.
3. 2–3 sets of lab equipment permanently donated to host schools.
4. At the pilot school: 5 classrooms equipped with projectors, reaching every class through the curated video learning library, not only the mentee cohort.
5. A sustained Grade 9–12 (or 9–10) mentee cohort of ~20–30 students receiving monthly, teacher-guided concept clinics for the full academic year.
6. A term-test score comparison for the mentee cohort against the rest of their grade, and a simple pre/post topic quiz per session, as concrete evidence of impact for CSR reporting rather than attendance numbers alone.
7. A curated, syllabus-aligned book and video-content library established at the pilot school, continuing to function after the CSR funding cycle ends.
8. Increased student interest in science and reduced hesitation toward laboratory environments among first-time participants.
9. A documented, multi-site case study [Recipient Bank Name] can reference in its own CSR reporting to the Board and to NRB, with a clear phase-two scaling narrative.

12. Duration and Venue

Launch Events: 1 full day per location, 2–3 locations across the 2026–27 academic year, scheduled flexibly to align with school calendars and the bank's disbursement timeline.

Digital Pilot & Mentorship: Installed after the launch event at the selected pilot school; monthly sessions run across the remainder of the 2026–27 academic year (approximately 9 months, excluding school breaks and exam periods).

Venue: Rural or underserved secondary schools in Nepal, to be finalised jointly with [Recipient Bank Name], subject to an electricity and network feasibility check for the pilot site.

12. Organizing Body / Team

Name	Role	Responsibility
Manish Pandey	President & Founder, NSSR	Overall program design, partner liaison, technical oversight
[VP Name]	Vice President, NSSR	Facilitator coordination, event operations
[Secretary Name]	Secretary, NSSR	Documentation, reporting, correspondence
Host School Administration	Venue Partner	On-ground coordination, venue and student mobilization

13. Conclusion

This proposal offers [Recipient Bank Name] more than a single outreach event: a phased, evidence-based partnership that pairs immediate, visible reach (launch events at 2–3 schools) with a sustained, single-site model built around what the data and the research literature identify as the highest-leverage gap for rural Nepali students: not a lack of inspiration, but the day-to-day struggle to pass. The digital learning pilot, monthly near-peer mentorship, and curated reference library are designed to work together, are individually fundable, and give [Recipient Bank Name] a renewable CSR story rather than a one-time event. NSSR welcomes the opportunity to discuss this proposal further and to tailor the host locations, timeline, or form of contribution to fit the bank's CSR priorities.

With regards,

Manish Pandey

President & Founder, Nepalese Society of Student Researchers (NSSR)

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